

Weak Two-bids

Open 2♦, 2♥ or 2♠ with a 6-card suit headed by some honors and fewer 4-9 HCP.

Response of a new suit is not forcing. (Note: some pairs play this 1-round force)

Raise of Opener's suit is to play.

Response of 2NT is forcing and asks for further information.

After 2NT Response, Opener bids:

- 3 of original suit to show a weak hand

- 3 of another suit to show a good hand with high card in that suit

- 3NT with a suit of A K Q x x x

Preemptive Bids

An opening bid of 3 of any suit shows a 7-card suit and less than opening hand.

This is primarily a defensive bid, and you should be mindful of vulnerability, being more cautious when you are Vulnerable against Non-Vulnerable opponents. For these Deals assume neither side is Vulnerable.

As a rule of thumb, Responder should assume Opener can win six tricks and bid accordingly.

Board: 1
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: North
Lead:  K

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 4 
Declarer: East
Lead:  4

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 3 
Declarer: South
Lead:  J

Board: 4
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: West
Lead:  K

Board: 5
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: North
Lead:  K

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 8 4 2
♥ A 10 8 5 4
♦ 8 4 2
♣ 4

♠ A Q 10
♥ K Q J
♦ Q J 10 3
♣ A J 10



♠ K 7 6 5
♥ 9 3 2
♦ A K 6 5
♣ 6 3

♠ J 3
♥ 7 6
♦ 9 7
♣ K Q 9 8 7 5 2

SOUTH doesn't have much of a 3♣ opening bid.

But NORTH has just the type of hand you need to bid 3NT after partner's preempt. The other three suits well stopped, and certain entry in Opener's long suit. Notice here that 3NT is a good contract, but 5♣ would go down 1.

West	North	East	South
Pass	3NT		3♣
All Pass			
3NT by North			
Lead: ♦ K			

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A Q 6 3

♥ Q 8 2

♦ A K Q

♣ K Q J

♠ K 9 8 2

♥ A 4

♦ 10 9 2

♣ 10 9 7 5



♠ J 4

♥ K J 10 9 6 3

♦ 8 7 5

♣ 4 2

♠ 10 7 5

♥ 7 5

♦ J 6 4 3

♣ A 8 6 3

When EAST opens with a Weak 2♥ bid, WEST knows she will force to game but is thinking about slam.

But first she needs to know if EAST has anything extra. She bids 2NT to get more information.

EAST returns to ♥s to show bare minimum so WEST settles for game.

*West**North**East**South*

2♥

Pass

2NT

Pass

3♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by East

Lead: ♦4

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 5
 ♥ 9 7 2
 ♦ J 10 8
 ♣ Q 9 7 5 2

♠ J 10 3
 ♥ A K 5 3
 ♦ A Q 7 3 2
 ♣ 4



♠ 7 4
 ♥ Q J 10
 ♦ K 6 5
 ♣ A J 10 8 3

♠ K Q 9 8 6 2
 ♥ 8 6 4
 ♦ 9 4
 ♣ K 6

NORTH has one of those hands which might or might not be helpful to SOUTH. He needs more information about SOUTH's hand, so he bids 2NT.

SOUTH has a better than average hand, so she bids 3♣ to show a high card in the suit.

NORTH was hoping for a high card in ♦s rather than ♣s, so he signs off in 3♠

West	North	East	South
			2♠
Pass	2NT	Pass	3♣
Pass	3♠		
All Pass			
3♠ by South			
Lead: ♦J			

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 6 4
♥ Q 4 2
♦ A J 4
♣ A K 6 5

♠ K Q 10 5

♥ A J 6

♦ 9 3

♣ J 7 3 2



♠ 7 3

♥ K 5 3

♦ K Q 10 8 7 2

♣ 9 4

♠ J 9 8 2

♥ 10 9 8 7

♦ 6 5

♣ Q 10 8

With four fast winners WEST should think about game. The best approach is usually to use 2NT to find out more about EAST's hand.

WEST found out that EAST has good opening strength, and, most importantly, either the ♥A or ♥K. Now that she doesn't have to worry about the opponents taking the first five ♥ tricks she bids 3NT.

West	North	East	South
		2♦	Pass
2NT	Pass	3♥	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			
3NT by West			
Lead: ♠K			

Board 5

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ J 6 4 3 2

♥ Q 10 9 5

♦ 5

♣ 9 4 2

♠ K Q 8

♥ A K 8

♦ J 4 3

♣ A 10 6 5



♠ A 10

♥ J 4 3 2

♦ 10 8 7

♣ K Q J 7

♠ 9 7 5

♥ 7 6

♦ A K Q 9 6 2

♣ 8 3

NORTH is strong enough to be thinking about game, depending on how good SOUTH's hand is. So he bids 2NT to get more information.

SOUTH has the exact hand to say 3NT - a suit headed by AKQ.

Game (and bidding) doesn't get much easier.

West	North	East	South
			2 ♦
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by North			
Lead: ♣K			